

Comey is charged with lying to Congress

Raises questions about weaponization of Justice

By Eric Tucker, Alanna Durkin Richer, and Michael Kunzelman
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Former FBI director James Comey was charged Thursday with lying to Congress in a criminal case filed days after President Trump appeared to urge his attorney general to prosecute Comey and other perceived political enemies.

The indictment makes Comey the first former senior government official involved in one of Trump’s chief grievances, the long-concluded investigation into Russian interference in the 2016 election, to face prosecution. Trump has for years derided that investigation as a “hoax” and a “witch hunt” despite multiple government reviews showing Moscow interfered on behalf of the Republican’s campaign, and has made clear his desire for retribution.

Trump on Thursday hailed the indictment as “JUSTICE FOR AMERICA!” Attorney General Pam Bondi, a Trump loyalist, and FBI Director Kash Patel, a longtime vocal critic of the Russia investigation, issued similar statements. “No one is above the law,” Bondi said.

COMEY, Page A6

Kraft selling small stakes in Patriots

Deals put franchise value at more than \$9 billion

By Michael Silverman
GLOBE STAFF

The Kraft family will no longer be the sole owner of the New England Patriots after it agreed to sell small stakes to two investment firms, in deals that value the franchise at more than \$9 billion, a team source confirmed on Thursday.

Businessman Dean Metropoulos, known in business circles for reviving troubled consumer brands, has an agreement to buy a 5 percent stake in the team, while the second deal, for a 3 percent stake, is with the Sixth Street investment

►Metropoulos made billions turning shattered brands into American staples. B5

firm, which recently bought into the NBA’s Boston Celtics ownership group. Sports Business Journal was first to report news of the deal.

Terms of the two transactions were not disclosed. But based on a valuation of at least \$9 billion, Metropoulos’s 5 percent stake would equate to at least \$450 million, while Sixth Street’s at least \$270 million. And the Patriots get a huge infusion of money without the Kraft family having to give up control of the jewel of its suite of businesses.

PATRIOTS, Page A7

BIG SHOW AT THE BIG E



The Big E in West Springfield attracts competitors and visitors from across New England, including the Maine 4-H Beef Team. Above, Kiley Gavett (right) showed her steer, Big Boy, during the showmanship contest. The event emphasizes poise, presentation, and control. At right, teens chanted, “Maine, Maine, Maine!” to rally votes during the scarecrow contest. Clockwise from top left are Lindsey McGee, Charlotte Choate, Kiley Gavett, and Sierra Hemond. The fair, formally known as the Eastern States Exposition, runs through Sunday. B3.



PHOTOS BY ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

‘Students need to trust that I’m able to navigate tough discussions.’

JOSHUA NGUYEN, whose name is on Turning Point’s Professor Watchlist

On Kirk’s watchlist, they teach in fear

Educators named by conservative group cite concern about careers — and safety

By Jessica Ma
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

When Joshua Nguyen assigns readings on a divisive topic — such as race, gender, or sexuality — he feels a flash of anxiety. His stress has only intensified since the slaying of Charlie Kirk brought the national debate over free expression and curriculum on college campuses to a boiling point.

Two years ago, Turning Point USA listed Nguyen, who teaches English at Boston College and Tufts, on Professor Watchlist, a website it launched in 2016. On his profile, it said Nguyen, who is pro-Palestinian rights, signed an open statement in solidarity and reposted a tweet call-

ing for a cease-fire in the Israel-Hamas War. He was named alongside at least 77 other educators who have worked at Massachusetts colleges and universities since the site’s launch.

The watchlist is dedicated to finding professors who Turning Point claims “discriminate against conservative students and advance leftist propaganda,” according to its website. Professors are targeted for their research and commentary on issues, spanning the war between Israel and Hamas, Palestinian rights, transgender rights, and racial justice.

“As a writer and a big supporter of free expression, it sucks that I feel

a little unsure,” Nguyen said. “Students need to trust that I’m able to navigate tough discussions.”

Nguyen, 31, said he is worried that being on a watchlist for an organization closely affiliated with the Trump administration could jeopardize future career opportunities, especially during a period where the administration is putting mounting pressure on academic institutions. He is a lecturer, not a tenured professor, and described himself as “the most expendable.”

In the aftermath of Kirk’s death, as some members of the far-right have campaigned to identify names, photos, and workplace details of people who criticized Kirk’s political rhetoric, the Professor Watchlist has received renewed attention. The list, which compiles profiles of educators

KIRK, Page A5

Mass. doctor in line for US role

Is front-runner to lead National Cancer Institute

By Matthew Herper and Angus Chen
STAT

Anthony Letai, a cancer researcher and oncologist at the Dana-Farber Cancer Institute and Harvard University, has emerged as a leading candidate to be the next director of the National Cancer Institute, according to multiple sources with direct knowledge of the situation.

The NCI is the largest institute or center at the National Institutes of Health and the only institute where the director is appointed by the president. A Health and Human Services spokesman declined to comment.

Word that Letai might be the next NCI director spread rapidly through the cancer research community. Cancer scientists who spoke with STAT expressed relief that Letai, who they described as both kind and an excellent, highly qualified scientist and physician, would likely lead the nation’s most important cancer research office.

“It’s an excellent choice, especially considering everything right now,” said Diana Azzam, a cancer researcher at Florida International University and a board member of the Society for Functional Precision Medicine where Letai serves as president. “He’s a great scientist,”

CANCER, Page A7

After protests and layoffs, Emerson looks ahead



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

In March, Emerson unveiled a new strategic plan to guide its growth over the next five years.

College faces challenges with finances, identity

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF
and Yogev Toby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Ribbons of purple and gold snaked down Boylston Street in August as new students arrived at Emerson College for the fall semester. The sidewalk across from Boston Common buzzed with move-in carts and freshmen eager to experience what one parent called Emerson’s “driven while artsy” vibe.

But among the crowd were a few disgruntled Emerson employees distributing leaflets that served as a stubborn reminder of issues the school is

eager to forget: rolling financial cuts, the 2024 arrests of pro-Palestinian protesters, and a campus left fractured in the aftermath.

“When the president lives in a \$5 million suite in the Ritz-Carlton, and librarians are being walked off their jobs, it begs the question,” read the leaflet from the staff union, angered by summertime layoffs. “What are Emerson’s priorities?”

The arts and communication college is facing the same financial challenges as small schools across the country. Slumping enrollment, mushrooming costs, and upheaval in federal higher education policy are driving more universities into the red. At Emerson, those problems are coming to a head

EMERSON, Page A5

Boston Public Schools administrators were to present changes to the city’s exam schools admission policy. B1.

Amazon has reached a \$2.5 billion settlement with the FTC, which said the online retail giant tricked customers into signing up for its Prime memberships. B5.

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Comics and Weather, G6-7.

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